

P1 Dust of Snow

(Robert Frost)

Rhyme scheme

ABAB, CDCD

Mood

The mood of the poem is uplifting and hopeful. The poem begins with a sense of gloom and regret, as the poet feels burdened by his emotions. However, the mood shifts to one of positivity and renewal when a simple act of nature changes the poet's perspective.

Tone

- Light and Cheerful.
- Depressing to optimistic

Message

The poem conveys that small, unexpected moments in nature can have a powerful impact on our emotions.

Justification of the title

It is simple yet meaningful, perfectly capturing the essence of the poem. The 'dust of snow' refers to fine particles of snow that fall on the poet, symbolizing a small, seemingly insignificant event in nature. This moment, however, has a profound impact on the poet's mood, lifting his spirits and saving a part of a regretful day.

THEME

- Power of nature
- Finding joy in small moments
- Positivity from negativity
- Emotional transformation

Poetic Devices

1. Alliteration- the occurrence of the same letter or sound at the beginning of adjacent or closely connected words.

- Has given my heart
- And saved some part

2. Inversion- A figure of speech where the normal word order of a sentence is rearranged.

stanza 1- "shook down on me."

3. Enjambment- the continuation of a sentence or phrase from one line to the next, without a pause or end-stopped line

stanza 1 & 2

4. Assonance- a literary technique where the same or similar vowel sound is repeated

Shook down on me

5. Symbolism- a poetic device where objects, people, places, or actions are used to represent ideas, qualities, or concepts beyond their literal meaning

- Crow-unexpected source of positivity, despite being traditionally associated with negativity.
- Hemlock tree-represents sorrow or negativity but brings about a positive change in the poet's mood.
- Dust of Snow- symbolises small, seemingly insignificant moments that can have a profound impact on one's emotions.

6. Synecdoche- a part of something is used to represent the whole, or vice versa.

Has given my heart

7. Metaphor- a figure of speech that compares two unlike things without using "like" or "as," directly stating that one thing is another.

Dust of snow

Practice Questions:

1. In our lives, we often label certain events or things as "bad" based on tradition or first impressions. How does this poem encourage the value of open-mindedness, and how can changing our perspective help us find "saved" moments in a day we might otherwise have "ruined"?

2. Compare Lencho's faith in God with the poet's faith in nature. Which do you think has a more practical impact on human life? Why?